Granola Growth Case: The Bridge from Talk to Work - Talk Track

case built for the Superhuman process - carlosluis duchicela - mar 2026

Slide 1 - The Bridge from Talk to Work

Main talk track

"At the highest level, I think Granola's next unlock is not helping people take slightly better notes. It's helping them turn meetings into actual work - and then making that work visible enough that it can start spreading across the team.

That distinction is the foundation of the case.

When I look at Granola, I see a product that already appears quite strong at capturing, structuring, and enhancing meeting context. But strong meeting intelligence does not automatically become durable business value.

The business value shows up downstream:

when the meeting becomes a follow-up,

a CRM update,

a project summary,

a next-step artifact,

a decision log,

or another execution-ready output.

So I reduced the system to two bridges.

The first is note to work. Can Granola help the original user reliably turn a meeting into something operationally useful?

The second is artifact to team pull. Once that output exists, can it be useful and visible enough that other people in the workflow care, trust it, and eventually want the same behavior for their own meetings?

Those two bridges became the organizing logic for everything else."

Why this slide matters

"This slide matters because it sets the scope correctly.

If I frame the problem too narrowly as 'better note quality,' I'll likely overbuild AI and underbuild behavior change.

If I frame it too broadly as 'team collaboration,' I'll likely solve too far downstream.

This framing gives me a more precise strategic question:

where in the path from meeting capture to team adoption is value leaking most?"

What would validate this framing

"I'd expect to see:

decent note quality or enhancement satisfaction

weaker execution conversion

weaker routing or downstream insertion

weak multi-user behavior despite solid individual utility"

What would disprove it

"If note trust and note value were weak from the start, then this framing would be too downstream and I'd need to move earlier in the product stack."

Likely Q&A

1. Why are you so confident this is bigger than notes?

"Because note products often create individual utility, but not necessarily team dependency. Team dependency shows up when the note becomes workflow."

2. Could this just be a packaging problem?

"Possibly in part, but I think packaging sits inside the broader workflow-conversion problem. Better packaging helps only if the product is already producing meaningful downstream artifacts."

3. Why define two bridges instead of one funnel?

"Because they're different causal problems. The first is activation quality. The second is expansion. They need different interventions and different metrics."

Slide 2 - Executive Summary

Main talk track

"My recommendation is to introduce Meeting-to-Execution Workflows.

The core idea is to make Granola less like a toolkit that users manually compose and more like a system that helps recurring, high-value meetings reliably produce the right downstream outputs with much less effort.

Concretely, that means:

the product identifies the likely meeting intent,

applies the right structure,

generates the right artifacts,

routes those artifacts to the right systems,

and remembers that behavior so it becomes easier to repeat.

I landed here because I think the biggest growth opportunity is not adding more product surface area. It's increasing the percentage of meetings that become execution-ready and eventually share-ready outputs.

If that conversion improves, the product gets:

stronger user value,

stronger repeat behavior,

stronger team visibility,

and eventually stronger monetization logic."

Why this slide matters

"This slide matters because I want to make the recommendation early, but not in a hand-wavy way.

I wanted the recommendation to satisfy three constraints.

First, it had to build on real product strengths that likely already exist.

Second, it had to target the highest-leverage bottleneck rather than a downstream symptom.

Third, it had to be testable with a narrow wedge before broader rollout.

This recommendation fits those constraints better than:

a generic collaboration layer,

a generic monetization layer,

or a 'more AI everywhere' strategy."

What would validate it

"More meetings producing work outputs, more repeat workflows, more artifacts reaching shared surfaces, and stronger multi-user signals."

What would disprove it

"If users still don't trust or repeat the outputs, or if value remains trapped with the author, then workflow composition is not enough."

Likely Q&A

1. Why one wedge instead of multiple parallel bets?

"Because I want one intervention that changes several connected behaviors at once rather than spreading effort across disconnected hypotheses."

2. Why not lead with premium features?

"Because premium works better when it attaches to demonstrated dependency. I want the product to earn monetization."

3. Is this a growth initiative or a core product initiative?

"It's both. The mechanism is product, but the reason to do it is because it changes the growth dynamics."

Slide 3 - Framework: Capture, Operationalize, Expand

Main talk track

"The framework I used is Capture, Operationalize, Expand.

Capture is the raw meeting-intelligence layer:

transcript, notes, enhancement, context.

Operationalize is where that intelligence becomes usable work:

templates, recipes, structured outputs, routing, workflow memory.

Expand is where that value escapes the original note and becomes useful beyond the author:

Slack, CRM, folders, team workspaces, repeated team usage.

I chose this framework because it maps much more directly to how Granola creates value than a generic SaaS funnel does."

Why this slide matters

"It lets me distinguish between different classes of product problems.

Capture problems are about note quality and trust.

Operationalization problems are about whether the product helps users complete downstream work.

Expansion problems are about whether that downstream value becomes visible and adoptable by others.

Without that separation, it's too easy to diagnose all growth weakness as a generic engagement problem."

What would validate it

"If the metrics separate by layer - for example, strong capture but weak operationalization and weaker expansion - then this framework is useful."

What would disprove it

"If Granola is uniformly weak or uniformly strong across all three layers, then the framework adds less value."

Likely Q&A

1. Why not activation / retention / monetization?

"Those are useful output lenses, but less useful for diagnosis here. Capture, Operationalize, Expand tells me where the value engine is weak."

2. Which layer is most promising today?

"Capture appears strongest. Operationalize looks like the most important gap."

3. Which layer drives monetization most directly?

"Expand, but only after Operationalize is strong enough to produce meaningful outputs."

Slide 4 - Granola's Latent Execution Potential

Main talk track

"One thing I wanted to avoid was solving the wrong problem.

Granola already appears to have many of the key ingredients:

meeting capture,

enhancement,

templates,

recipes,

destinations,

workspaces,

and workflow memory.

So I don't think the company is missing the raw primitives required to create workflow value.

The stronger hypothesis is that the product still asks the user to do too much composition work themselves.

In other words, it behaves more like a toolkit than a default workflow system.

That distinction matters a lot.

If the problem were missing primitives, I'd recommend building new capabilities.

If the problem is fragmented orchestration, then the right move is to make the system more opinionated, more defaulted, and easier to repeat."

Why this slide matters

"A lot of products respond to weak compounding by adding more features. If the real issue is fragmented composition, that can actually make adoption worse.

So this slide is really about narrowing the solution space."

What would validate it

"If existing primitives like notes, templates, and recipes are reasonably strong in isolation, but users still rarely get to robust downstream outputs, then composition is likely the right focus."

What would disprove it

"If those underlying primitives are materially weak, then I'd need to improve them before expecting orchestration to matter."

Likely Q&A

1. Why describe Granola as a toolkit today?

"Because the user still appears to be responsible for too much of the assembly - structure, output choice, routing, and sharing."

2. Could that be a good thing for power users?

"Yes, and I wouldn't want to eliminate flexibility. But for growth, the bigger unlock comes from strong defaults."

3. What is the risk of over-orchestrating?

"The risk is reducing user control or trust. That's why transparency and editability still matter."

Slide 5 - The Growth Model: Identifying Critical Value Leakage

Main talk track

"I modeled the growth system as:

meeting ? note ? enhanced note ? execution-ready artifact ? routed artifact ? shared value ? repeated usage ? workspace adoption.

Then I asked: where is value leaking?

I see three types of leakage.

First, individual leakage:

the meeting becomes a note, but not consistently work.

Second, expansion leakage:

the output may exist, but it may not be packaged or distributed in a way that creates value for others.

Third, team leakage:

even useful artifacts may not become repeatable or shared behavior across the workspace.

So the system captures value well, but fails to consistently convert, distribute, and repeat it."

Why this slide matters

"This leakage model matters because it stops me from treating weak team growth as purely a team feature problem. The weakness may be much earlier."

What would validate it

"I'd expect a step-down pattern:

strong note behavior,

weaker artifact behavior,

even weaker shared-system behavior,

and weaker still multi-user workflow behavior."

What would disprove it

"If the biggest drop-off is somewhere else entirely, then I'd revise where I think the system is leaking."

Likely Q&A

1. Which leakage is most expensive?

"Workflow conversion, because it weakens all the later layers."

2. Could expansion leakage be solved without fixing individual leakage?

"Possibly at the margin, but it would likely amplify low-quality or inconsistent value."

3. Why use leakage language instead of funnel drop-off?

"Because leakage is closer to causal value loss. Funnel drop-off is descriptive; leakage is more diagnostic."

Slide 6 - Workflow Conversion is the Primary First-Order Bottleneck

Main talk track

"This is where I choose the bottleneck.

I considered four plausible first-order constraints:

weak note value,

weak workflow conversion,

weak reach expansion,

and weak team expansion.

I landed on workflow conversion as the strongest first-order bottleneck.

Why?

Because it sits in the middle of the value chain and unlocks both activation quality and downstream expansion.

If the note doesn't become a strong output, then:

the user gets less practical value,

the behavior is less repeatable,

there's less reason to share it,

and there's less for teammates to adopt.

So workflow conversion is not just important - it's leverageable."

Why this slide matters

"This is the core analytical decision in the deck. I'm not just naming a problem. I'm selecting the constraint that, if solved, has the highest downstream leverage."

How I got there

"I eliminated the other options.

If note value were the main issue, I'd expect the weakness to show up earlier in note trust or enhancement satisfaction.

If reach expansion were the main issue, I'd expect strong outputs that simply aren't traveling.

If team expansion were the main issue, I'd expect strong outputs and strong reach, but weak multi-user adoption.

The current theory is that too few meetings are becoming robust, execution-ready outputs in the first place."

What would validate it

"Strong note quality, weaker note-to-output conversion, weaker recipe/routing behavior, and visible upside from better post-note orchestration."

What would disprove it

"If note trust is weak, or if users don't find the outputs valuable enough to use even once."

Likely Q&A

1. Why is this first-order rather than just one of several issues?

"Because it sits at the point where value either starts compounding or dies."

2. What's the fastest leading indicator here?

"Execution-ready artifact conversion."

3. Could reach still be the bigger issue?

"Yes, but only if outputs are already strong and under-distributed. Right now I think outputs themselves are still under-converted."

Slide 8 - Two Moments That Matter

Main talk track

"I compress the system into two moments.

First, note to work. That's the activation unlock. Did the meeting become something that saves time and completes work?

Second, artifact to team pull. That's the expansion unlock. Did the output become useful and visible enough that it starts creating demand from others?

Those are the two top-level moments I'd optimize around.

Below that, I included the lower-level mechanics that explain how the system works:

template usage,

contextual trigger,

recipe invocation,

workflow logic,

shared-surface insertion,

structured SOR data,

repeat workflow,

and repeat across team.

So the top two moments are the strategic frame, and the lower moments are the operating chain."

Why this slide matters

"It gives me a way to talk about the business problem at two levels:

a simple top-level narrative for strategy,

and a lower-level behavioral chain for execution."

What would validate this model

"If strengthening workflow logic and shared insertion produces the biggest movement in conversion, repeatability, and reach, then this model is useful."

What would disprove it

"If weaker-looking upstream steps like capture or enhance turn out to be the real bottlenecks."

Likely Q&A

1. Why is note-to-work first?

"Because that's where latent note value becomes actual user value."

2. Why separate artifact-to-team-pull from repeat workflow?

"Because team pull is downstream of one user repeating the behavior. Repeat workflow is a habit signal; team pull is an expansion signal."

3. If you only optimized one of the lower mechanics, which would you choose?

"Workflow logic or recipe invocation first, because that is what makes the note operational."

Slide 9 - The Constraint Hierarchy

Main talk track

"This slide shows the dependency order in the system.

At the bottom are product and UX conditions:

are workflows easy enough, default enough, and trusted enough?

Above that are behavioral signals:

are users converting notes into outputs and repeating them?

Above that is reach:

are those outputs entering shared systems?

Above that is expansion:

are other users or workspaces starting to depend on them?

And only then do I get monetization.

That hierarchy matters because it tells me not just what matters, but when it matters."

Why this slide matters

"It prevents me from jumping too quickly to premium packaging or team surfaces before the underlying behavior exists."

What would validate it

"I'd expect better conversion and repeat usage to precede stronger multi-user and monetization signals."

What would disprove it

"If monetization or team growth moved independently of those earlier behaviors."

Likely Q&A

1. Where does trust live in the hierarchy?

"Across the lower layers, especially between product-system design and behavioral adoption."

2. Could monetization itself shape behavior?

"Yes, but I think durable monetization here should attach to demonstrated value and dependency."

3. Which layer is most fragile?

"The step from workflow availability to repeated user behavior."

Slide 10 - Recommendation: Meeting-to-Execution Workflows

Main talk track

"The recommendation is to introduce Meeting-to-Execution Workflows.

For selected recurring, high-value meetings, the product should:

identify the meeting type,

apply the right structure,

generate the likely outputs,

route those outputs to the right systems,

and remember that behavior for future use.

The key shift is from optional tools to default orchestration.

Instead of asking the user to assemble the workflow themselves, the product carries more of that burden.

And the recommendation deliberately distinguishes between two output classes:

System Route, meaning structured output into a system of record,

and Recipient-Optimized Output, meaning share-ready artifacts for teammates.

That distinction matters because structured system value and team-facing value are not the same thing."

Why this slide matters

"This slide translates the diagnosis into the product concept."

What would validate it

"Higher execution-ready artifact conversion, stronger repeat workflow behavior, more share-ready outputs, and stronger shared-surface insertion."

What would disprove it

"If the workflow feels too opinionated, too noisy, or too low-trust to repeat."

Likely Q&A

1. Why use meeting type as the organizing principle?

"Because meeting type is one of the strongest predictors of downstream output needs."

2. Why not broader customization first?

"Because defaults are the growth unlock. Customization is valuable later, but not the first-order growth move."

3. What's the risk of opinionated workflows?

"The risk is reduced trust or reduced flexibility. That's why previewability and editability matter."

Slide 11 - Execution Strategy: MVP Wedge

Main talk track

"This is the narrowest, cleanest place I'd start.

The MVP wedge focuses on recurring, high-value meeting types with clear outputs and clear destinations.

Examples are customer discovery, demos, onboarding, account management, sprint planning, standups, hiring interviews, and team syncs - workflows where the meeting naturally wants to become:

a CRM update,

a follow-up,

a status summary,

a system-of-record entry,

or another structured output. The current slide separates commercial and internal workflow wedges, which is useful because it shows the same system can create value in both external-facing and operational contexts.

What makes this the right wedge is that it is both strategically relevant and operationally efficient.

On the strategic side, it directly tests the first-order bottleneck: can more meetings become execution-ready work?

On the execution side, it is relatively low cost and high signal.

It mostly requires:

UI orchestration,

default structure,

output formatting,

and lightweight workflow memory.

It does not require us to start by building the most expensive parts of the eventual system.

So this wedge is:

narrow enough to learn quickly,

strong enough to matter,

and reversible if the hypothesis is wrong."

Explicit effort / engineering reasoning

"The effort lens matters here.

I'd describe this wedge as relatively low engineering dependency compared to later phases, because it doesn't yet require full multi-user logic, deep permissions, billing work, or the broadest integration complexity.

That's important because I want the first test to maximize learning while minimizing irreversible system cost."

Clarifying MVP wedge vs phases vs prototype

"This is also where I'd clarify a distinction that matters across the deck.

The MVP wedge is where we start.

It maps mainly to Phase 1 and Phase 2 of the broader execution plan:

conversion and early habit.

And in the prototype, it shows up as the MVP state plus the beginning of Workflow Mode.

So the wedge is not a separate system from the phase plan or the prototype. It is simply the first narrow slice of that system."

What would validate it

"Meaningful improvement in execution-ready artifact conversion, and early signs of repeat workflow behavior."

What would disprove it

"If users still don't trust or reuse the outputs, even in these high-value contexts."

Likely Q&A

1. Why these meeting types first?

"They maximize frequency, output clarity, and business relevance."

2. Why say this is low effort?

"Because it avoids the most expensive and tightly coupled work until the core hypothesis is proven."

3. How is this different from the whole workflow vision?

"This wedge tests the first two phases of the broader system - conversion and habit - before scaling into broader reach and team dynamics."

Slide 12 - The 5-Phase Execution Plan

Main talk track

"This slide is the causal rollout plan for the system.

Phase 1 is conversion:

can more meetings become execution-ready outputs?

Phase 2 is habit:

do users begin repeating those workflows?

Phase 3 is reach:

do the outputs start escaping the note and entering shared systems?

Phase 4 is team adoption:

do other users or the workspace start reusing the pattern?

Phase 5 is scale and monetization:

once those behaviors are strong enough, how do we expand the system and monetize the dependency it creates?

The key thing to understand is that this 5-phase plan is not different from the wedge or the prototype. It is the same system expressed at the rollout level.

The MVP wedge is how we start Phase 1 and 2.

Workflow Mode in the prototype corresponds to proving habit.

The Expansion state in the prototype corresponds to Phases 3 through 5, where reach turns into adoption and eventually monetization pressure."

Explicit effort sequencing

"This slide is also where I'd make the effort logic explicit.

Phase 1 and 2 are lower cost and high signal:

UI logic, workflow composition, lightweight memory, strong defaults.

Phase 3 and 4 are more system-coupled:

shared-system insertion, more recipient-aware outputs, more multi-user logic.

Phase 5 is the highest cost and highest coupling:

billing, limits, workspace-level monetization pressure, broader scaling.

We intentionally defer the most expensive and irreversible work until the earlier phases have proven that the workflow is valuable and repeatable." The slide already encodes that effort logic with low-cost UI/orchestration in phases 1-2, moderate distribution/team work in phases 3-4, and high billing/scale work in phase 5.

Clarifying "first wedge has to earn expansion"

"When I say the first wedge has to earn expansion, what I mean is:

the wedge must prove enough conversion and repeatability that it makes sense to invest in broader distribution, team surfaces, and monetization.

It does not mean the wedge itself fully solves expansion.

It means it creates the preconditions for expansion to be worth pursuing."

What would validate it

"Phase 1 and 2 producing strong enough signals to justify the more expensive work in phases 3 to 5."

What would disprove it

"If the wedge improves one-off outputs but doesn't create repeated behavior."

Likely Q&A

1. Are MVP wedge, 5 phases, and prototype states overlapping concepts?

"Yes, but intentionally. They're the same system viewed from three different lenses: strategy entry point, causal rollout, and user experience."

2. Why not build Slack and CRM fully in the wedge?

"Because those are more expensive and more useful once the workflow itself has earned them."

3. What would stop you from moving into Phase 3?

"Weak conversion, weak repeatability, or weak trust."

Slide 13 - Prototype: The Seamless Meeting-to-Execution Flow

Main talk track

"Now I'll use the prototype to make the system concrete from the user's perspective.

The prototype is designed to feel less like a note editor and more like an intelligent workflow runner. It's showing how the system behaves once the workflow layer exists. The current deck frames this through trust and control, which is directionally right: the goal is augmentation, not black-box automation.

I start from the Home state because Home makes accumulated value visible over time. Early on, the product is mostly creating individual value. After the MVP wedge, it reflects a successful workflow outcome. After Workflow Mode, it reflects repeat usage and time saved. At the Expansion Trigger, it reflects that the workflow is now spreading enough to create real team value and plan pressure.

Then I move into the first flow.

The user is a commercial operator - for example, an AE or account owner - running a high-value meeting like a discovery call.

The first key moment is that the meeting does not end as a note. It becomes a structured, execution-ready output:

a CRM-ready artifact,

a follow-up,

a clear set of next steps,

and a summary that is actually usable.

That proves the first bridge:

note to work.

Then I move to Workflow Mode.

This is where the same user runs a similar but distinct high-value workflow again - not the exact same demo artifact, but the same workflow class showing reuse. That matters because the point is not that Granola can help once. The point is that the product can make the behavior repeatable.

Here the workflow is:

saved,

recognized,

reused,

and increasingly becomes part of the user's weekly process.

That proves habit.

Then the output leaves the author's note and enters Slack and CRM.

Slack matters because it creates contextual visibility.

A teammate can encounter the output where they already work.

CRM matters because it creates operational consequence.

The artifact becomes part of a system of record rather than just an ephemeral note.

Then I switch to the second user's point of view.

A teammate sees the Slack update,

looks at the CRM entry,

and then runs a related workflow themselves.

That matters because expansion is not just about one user sharing more. It's about another user pulling the behavior into their own process.

Then I come back to the admin or workspace-level surfaces.

Now:

more workflows have been run,

more teammates have been reached,

some are adopting the pattern,

and the product begins to hit real usage limits.

That's where the monetization moment becomes natural.

So the prototype is showing one closed loop:

meeting ? work output ? repeated workflow ? shared system value ? teammate pull ? workspace growth ? monetization pressure."

Meta commentary on design choices

"The design choices in the prototype are intentional.

Home is the anchor because it shows the product as a compounding behavior engine, not a one-off feature.

The first flow uses a high-value recurring commercial meeting because those meetings have the cleanest output logic.

Workflow Mode uses a similar but different meeting context because the point is reuse across a workflow category, not replaying the exact same meeting.

Slack is used to show contextual visibility and teammate pull.

CRM is used to show trust and operational consequence.

The second user flow exists because team expansion is stronger when it is experienced as recipient value first, then workflow adoption second.

And the admin / analytics / billing surfaces exist because the point of this strategy is not just productivity. It's to create account-level dependency that can eventually be monetized."

What would validate it

"If the real product starts showing stronger conversion, stronger repeat workflow behavior, stronger shared insertion, stronger teammate interaction, and eventually stronger multi-user usage."

What would disprove it

"If the prototype logic works only visually but not behaviorally - for example, one-off outputs improve but repeatability and expansion don't."

Likely Q&A

1. What is the most important transition in the prototype?

"MVP wedge to Workflow Mode, because that's where convenience becomes habit."

2. Why use Home as the anchor?

"Because it shows the system as a compounding workspace behavior engine, not a one-time feature."

3. What role do Slack and CRM play differently?

"Slack proves visibility and pull. CRM proves trust and operational consequence."

Slide 14 - Engineering Teammate Pull via Recipient-Optimized Artifacts

Main talk track

"This slide isolates one of the most important assumptions in the strategy:

that artifacts can become the growth mechanism.

I don't think the strongest team growth motion starts with invites.

I think it starts when a teammate receives something genuinely useful in their existing work context.

But for that to happen, the artifact has to be optimized for the recipient, not just the author.

A strong author-facing note is not automatically a strong teammate-facing artifact.

To create pull, the output has to be:

concise,

role-relevant,

low-edit,

and context-rich.

If that works, a teammate experiences value before ever making an explicit adoption decision. That's much stronger than asking them to opt into something abstract."

Why this slide matters

"It explains why shared surfaces alone are not enough. Expansion depends on the quality of the artifact from the recipient's perspective."

What would validate it

"Recipient interaction, follow-on workflow usage, and eventual multi-user adoption."

What would disprove it

"If artifacts are consumed but never lead to behavior change."

Likely Q&A

1. Why is artifact quality so important?

"Because expansion depends on recipient value, not just sender value."

2. Why not rely on general sharing?

"Because passive visibility is weaker than contextual, role-relevant value."

3. What if recipient needs differ a lot by role?

"Then artifact shaping likely needs to become role-aware over time."

Slide 15 - Experiment Design: Testing the MVP Wedge

Main talk track

"This slide is the actual experiment design for the first wedge.

The broader strategy is Meeting-to-Execution Workflows, but the first experiment is narrower. Its purpose is to test whether composed workflows improve the percentage of recurring, high-value meetings that become execution-ready and share-ready outputs.

The hypothesis is:

if Granola bundles meeting-type defaults, structured outputs, routing, and workflow memory into one guided flow, then more eligible meetings will become completed work and more of that work will escape the note into shared systems.

The pilot scope is selected recurring, high-value meetings like discovery, demos, onboarding, and account management.

The design is a user-level randomized test.

The control is the current experience, where notes, templates, recipes, and routing require more manual assembly.

The treatment is the composed workflow experience.

At 7 days, I look at conversion.

At 14 days, I look at repeat use.

At 30 days, I look at whether value is escaping the note.

The current slide quantifies that with:

+20% lift in execution-ready artifact conversion

+10% lift in share-ready artifact conversion

+15% lift in workflow repeat rate

and note satisfaction maintained at or above 4.5 as the guardrail. "

Why this slide matters

"This is where the strategy becomes falsifiable. I'm no longer just describing a system I like. I'm defining the experiment that would prove or disprove the wedge."

Table walkthrough

"The first primary metric is execution-ready artifact conversion.

That tells me whether the note is actually becoming useful work.

The second primary metric is share-ready artifact conversion.

That tells me whether value is starting to escape the note.

Then I look at workflow repeat rate as the habit signal.

And I keep note satisfaction as the guardrail, because a workflow layer that harms core note trust is not a win."

What would validate it

"Lift in execution-ready artifacts, lift in share-ready outputs, stronger repeat workflow use, and stable satisfaction."

What would disprove it

"Minimal lift, weak trust, or local output improvement without note escape."

Likely Q&A

1. Why is this the MVP experiment and not the full system test?

"Because I want to isolate the first-order bottleneck cleanly."

2. Why include share-ready artifacts this early?

"Because I want to know whether the wedge starts creating value escape, not just local productivity."

3. Why user-level randomization?

"Because habit and repeat workflow behavior are user-level effects."

Slide 16 - The North Star: Driving Habitual Team Execution

Main talk track

"The North Star here is not more notes, more meetings, or more AI usage.

It's weekly execution-ready plus share-ready workflows per workspace.

I like this North Star because it captures both:

habit at the user level

and scaling at the workspace level

It's the clearest single metric that tells me the system is actually working as intended:

meetings are being converted into execution-ready work

that work is usable beyond the original author

and that behavior is repeating within the account

So instead of measuring output volume, we're measuring whether work is actually getting completed and reused inside a team context.

The child metrics underneath it map directly to each stage of the system.

On the activation side:

% conversion to execution-ready artifacts

This tells me whether we are successfully turning notes into usable work outputs.

On the habit side:

% repeat workflow usage

This tells me whether users are coming back and reusing the same workflow across meetings, which is the core signal of behavioral stickiness.

On the expansion side:

% share-ready artifacts pushed into systems of record like Slack or CRM

This tells me whether value is escaping the individual user and becoming visible to the rest of the team.

And then the phase-gate criteria tell me whether I've earned the right to scale beyond the wedge.

For Phase 1, I'm looking for:

Conversion:

40% of eligible notes becoming execution-ready outputs

Repeatability:

25% of users invoking the same workflow on a recurring basis

Satisfaction:

CSAT at or above 4.5 on output quality

Reach (directional):

Shared artifact insertion rate improving over time

Each of these is doing something specific:

conversion proves we can generate usable work

repeatability proves that work is becoming a habit

satisfaction ensures we're not degrading core value

reach proves that value is starting to move beyond the individual

So this slide is doing two things at once:

it defines the system-level North Star, which compounds across users, workflows, and teams

and it defines the scale / don't scale logic, which ensures we only expand once the wedge proves both conversion and repeatability

The key idea is that we don't scale on activity.

We scale on validated behavior change that translates into team-level usage."

Why this slide matters

"It makes the experiment operational and disciplined.

I'm not just defining a North Star - I'm tying it to:

clear behavioral stages (activation, habit, expansion)

explicit success thresholds

and a gating mechanism that prevents premature scaling

It ensures we only invest in expansion once the system proves it can reliably convert meetings into repeatable, shareable work."

What would validate it

"Strong movement in:

execution-ready workflows per workspace

repeat workflow usage rates

and share-ready artifacts entering Slack or CRM

with conversion, repeatability, and satisfaction all clearing the defined thresholds.

That would tell me the wedge is working end-to-end, not just in isolated parts."

What would disprove it

"If we see:

conversion increasing, but repeat usage remains low

repeat usage increasing, but outputs are not shared or visible to the team

or strong usage paired with declining satisfaction

then the system is not actually compounding, and we have not earned the right to scale."

Likely Q&A

1. Why use workspace as the unit, not user?

"Because the long-term commercial model is driven by account-level dependency.

A single user getting value is not sufficient.

We need workflows to become part of how a team operates, and workspace-level aggregation captures that transition from individual usage to team-level adoption."

2. Why not make repeat usage the North Star directly?

"Because repeat usage alone can overstate value.

Users can repeat low-value actions.

The North Star ensures that what is repeating is both:

execution-ready

and shareable

So we're measuring quality + reuse, not just frequency."

3. Why combine execution-ready and share-ready into one North Star?

"Because we need both to be true for the system to scale.

Execution-ready alone gives us individual productivity.

Share-ready alone gives us visibility.

But the combination is what creates:

reusable workflows

team exposure

and ultimately expansion and monetization

So combining them ensures we're optimizing for the full system, not just one stage."

Slide 17 - Impact Sizing / Directional Economics

Main talk track

"This slide translates the behavioral shifts we've been discussing into directional business impact, and ties them explicitly to a set of modeled assumptions.

I'm deliberately treating these economics as directional, not predictive, but the goal is to show that the system we're designing has multiple credible paths to revenue.

The model starts with a defined cohort of roughly 500K workflow-eligible users.

That comes from narrowing the total user base down to users who are consistently in recurring, workflow-relevant meetings, which is where repeatable behavior can actually form.

From there, we assume a +10 point lift in two key behaviors:

execution-ready outputs

share-ready artifacts

That translates into:

~50K additional execution-ready outputs

~50K additional share-ready artifacts

From that base, the economics break into three pathways, which map directly to how value is created and captured in the product.

First, retention.

50K outputs × 15% reuse ? ~7.5K repeat users

7.5K × 8-10% paid ? ~600-750 paid users

ARPU ? $14/month

This yields:

~$100K to $125K in ARR

The key idea here is that workflows create repeat behavior, and repeat behavior increases the likelihood of paid retention.

Second, premium clarity.

500K cohort × 1-2% upgrade ? ~5K-10K users

ARPU ? $14/month

This yields:

~$840K to $1.68M in ARR

This is the largest component because it's driven by clearer value perception across the entire cohort, not just the most engaged users.

Third, team expansion.

50K share-ready artifacts ? ~75K-100K exposures

2-3% conversion ? ~1.5K-3K new users

ARPU ? $12-$14

This yields:

~$200K to $500K in ARR

This is where value escapes the individual user and starts driving account-level growth.

Importantly, these pathways are not additive.

The same users can:

reuse workflows

upgrade

bring in teammates

So instead of summing them directly, we apply two adjustments:

Pathway realization ? how much of each pathway actually materializes

Overlap adjustment ? how much double-counting we remove

That's what drives the three scenario bands at the bottom:

Conservative:

Partial realization, high overlap

? ~$100K-$250K

Base case:

Strong activation, moderate expansion, typical overlap

? ~$600K-$1.2M

Upside:

Strong realization across all pathways, especially expansion and premium

? ~$1.5M-$2M+

I would frame these as scenario bands rather than precise forecasts.

What matters more than the exact number is the shape of the economics.

The system compounds across three layers:

individual productivity ? outputs become execution-ready

behavioral habit ? workflows get reused

team adoption ? artifacts create exposure and drive expansion

And the majority of the value ultimately comes from that third layer, where workflows become part of how a team operates, not just how one person takes notes."

Why this slide matters

It proves the system is economically meaningful, not just a UX improvement

It connects product behavior ? revenue pathways ? ARR impact

It shows multiple independent levers, not a single fragile bet

It demonstrates analytical rigor + structured thinking under uncertainty

It makes clear that expansion, not just usage, is the primary driver of upside

Q&A (what you should be ready for)

1. "Where did these assumptions come from?"

"These are benchmarked assumptions mapped to specific behavioral stages.

15% reuse reflects template/workflow reuse rates in tools like Notion or Zapier

8-10% paid reflects conversion among high-intent users, not top-of-funnel

1-2% upgrade reflects typical freemium conversion at the cohort level

2-3% expansion reflects passive exposure conversion from surfaces like Slack or shared docs

Each assumption is tied to a specific behavior in the system and is designed to be testable."

2. "Why can't you just add the three pathways together?"

"Because the same users can contribute to multiple pathways.

A user who:

reuses a workflow

upgrades

and shares it with teammates

would be counted three times if we summed directly.

So we explicitly apply an overlap adjustment to avoid double-counting, and that's what brings the gross potential down into the net scenario ranges."

3. "What assumption matters most / what breaks the model?"

"The most sensitive assumption is actually premium conversion.

That's the largest revenue driver, so if workflow value doesn't clearly translate into willingness to pay, the model compresses significantly.

The second most important is expansion conversion, because that determines whether value escapes the individual user.

Retention matters, but it's a smaller contributor relative to the other two."

Slide 18 - Tradeoffs

Main talk track

"This slide is about discipline.

A strategy is not just what I do. It's also what I choose not to do.

I'm explicitly choosing:

workflow composition over broader collaboration surfaces

a narrow wedge over broad multi-surface rollout

defaults over maximum flexibility

and signal-rich recurring workflows over generic coverage

Why?

Because I want to maximize learning velocity and reduce unnecessary system complexity early.

There are many things Granola could build.

But the point of this plan is to target the highest-leverage constraint first, with the minimum level of product and engineering complexity required to get a clean read."

Why this slide matters

"It shows prioritization discipline and product judgment."

What would validate it

"If the wedge gives a clean read on conversion and repeatability quickly."

What would disprove it

"If the narrow approach misses the real constraint because it is overly scoped."

Likely Q&A

1. Why not solve team collaboration more directly?

"Because I think team collaboration is downstream of stronger workflow value and artifact quality."

2. Why not maximize flexibility?

"Because growth usually comes from strong defaults before it comes from configurable power."

3. What's the biggest sacrifice here?

"We delay broader team surfaces and monetization work until the behavior earns them."

Slide 19 - Risks

Main talk track

"The final slide is the realism check.

There are real risks here.

One is that the workflow layer may be too aggressive and reduce trust.

Another is that users may value the outputs but not actually change their routine, which would mean we improve convenience without creating habit.

Another is that artifacts may travel, but still fail to create teammate pull because they are not compelling enough from the recipient's perspective.

And another is that even if short-term metrics improve, the economics may not become meaningful at the account level.

So this strategy is not 'build workflow magic and everything works.'

It is:

test the bottleneck,

watch the behavioral signals closely,

and scale only if conversion, repeatability, and reach reinforce each other."

Why this slide matters

"It closes the case in a credible way. I want to show confidence in the logic, but also realism about what could fail."

What would validate it

"If the wedge moves the right leading indicators and those signals begin compounding at the workspace level."

What would disprove it

"If the product becomes more sophisticated without producing stronger repeated behavior or team value."

Likely Q&A

1. Which risk worries you most?

"Habit risk. A workflow that helps once but doesn't become routine won't create the compounding behavior I'm looking for."

2. What's the most important mitigation?

"Strong defaults plus strong transparency. The user needs to understand and trust what the workflow is doing."

3. When would you kill or narrow the bet?

"If conversion improves but repeatability and reach stay weak, or if the system creates output without changing behavior."

Closing narrative you can use after the final slide

"If I step back, the logic of the case is:

Granola already appears strong at meeting capture and note intelligence.

The growth gap is that too little of that intelligence becomes completed work, and too little of that work becomes team-visible enough to create pull.

So I'd start by fixing note-to-work conversion through Meeting-to-Execution Workflows, prove that behavior in a narrow wedge, then expand only once conversion and habit are strong enough to support shared-system reach, team adoption, and monetization.

That's why I think the right first move is not more AI, not broader collaboration, and not monetization-first packaging.

It's workflow composition."